

7-0 (A)

Colorado Field Ornithologists Sight Record Form (This is a two-page report. Please print or type. Attach photographs and additional pages if necessary.) Each table cell will automatically enlarge as you type!

CFO-RC FILE X:

Rcd 10/23/00 wpe
(video)

RESULTS:

Species:(Common Name) Sharp-tailed Sandpiper (Scientific Name) Calidris acuminata

Date(s) of occurrence: 10-4-00

Number of birds seen: one Sex: Plumage: juvenile

Exact location: 1 1/2 miles east of BCR 17 on the north side of BCR JJ

County: Nearest town: Las Animas, Bent County Elevation: approx. 4000 feet

Length of observation: one hour and fifteen minutes Time(s) of observation: 07:40 to 08:55

Other observers who saw the bird(s) with you: Mark Janos, Duane Nelson, Norm Erthal, Joey Kellnor and Dick Schottler

Other Observers who independently saw the bird(s): mob

Light Conditions (quality; direction relative to bird(s); position: cloudy; wind NE at 5 to 15 MPH, the bird was directly north of the road.

Optical equipment used: Ziess 10 x 40, Kowa TSN-4 scope, Sony Video cam

Distance from bird(s) (estimated unless otherwise noted): 40 feet to 70 yards

Was bird(s) photographed? yes If so, have you submitted photos? yes, video

Who took the photographs? myself

Describe the general and specific habitat in which the bird(s) occurred: mudflat with an edge of weeds, grasses and cattails.

Describe the bird's behavior (flying, feeding, habits, behaviors used in identifying the Species or in supporting the identification): The bird was observed feeding, preening, resting and flying in and among the weed edge and mudflats. The bird was loosely associated with a flock of dowitchers and less so with a group of Killdeer

Describe the bird in detail. This is the most important part of this report. Include the overall size and shape and how you placed the bird in the general group that you did. Give complete details of plumage, including head, throat, undersides, nape, back, wings and tail. Give particular emphasis to marks you used to identify the bird(s). Describe other important details, such as color and shape of bill, legs, eye, (etc.) that were important in making the identification. (Fill out this portion even if photographs are submitted; you may attach additional sheets, drawings, field sketches or copy field notes): The bird was a chlidris type sandpiper slightly smaller than a nearby Pectoral Sandpiper and noticeably smaller than the dowitchers and Killdeer. The bird had a rusty cap, faintly streaked with black, a white supercillium widening behind the eye. The buffy, gray eye stripe narrowed behind the eye. There was a faint white eye ring around the black eye. The chin and malar region were white. The bill was about the length of the head, very slightly drooped, grayer at the base and black at the tip. The breast was orangy, buff, clear in the center, lightly streaked with black toward the neck and flanks. The belly, flanks and under tail coverts were white. The legs were a greenish-yellow, pale. The back was a scaley buff and black with a bit of white. Very crisp looking. The tertials were a bright orangey, red buff. Probably the brightest part of the bird!

Describe bird's call or song: none heard

Discuss similar species and how you eliminated them: The Pectoral sandpiper was eliminated by the rusty cap, widening of the supercillium, buffy breast without streaking and a sharp demarkation between the breast and the belly.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species? None with Sharp-tails, seen some Pectorals

List books, guides, recordings or other sources consulted and how this influenced your identification (during and after observation): Nat. Geo. 3rd ed., Shorebirds (Hayman, Marchant, Prater)

This report is from notes made during or after observation or later X (watched the video many times) from memory

Date of written report: 10-15-00

Reporting observer: Ric Olson

Signature: Rcd

Reporting Observer's Address: 9450 N. Heather Dr., Castle Rock Co., 80104

City: State: Zip:

The enclosed video has birds other than the sharptailed sandpiper on it. Most of the footage was taken through a spotting scope. Ric